PRODUCT MANAGEMENT ASSIGNMENT

Growth Opportunities for X (Twitter)

A four-step AARRR funnel analysis — user journey, gaps, product epics and RICE prioritisation
Platform: **X (formerly Twitter)** | Framework: **AARRR + RICE**

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

X does not have an awareness problem — it has a habit problem. Despite over a billion Android downloads and hundreds of millions in ad reach, only around one in ten U.S. adults use the platform daily. The core issue is that X leaks too many users before they ever experience real value: sign-up is brittle, first-session relevance is weak, and there is no strong pull to return on ordinary days.

> Recommendation: Focus on Activation and Retention first — fix access, fix the first run, fix feed control, then build reasons to return. Revenue and Referral improvements follow once the funnel stops leaking.

Mapping the AARRR Funnel

How users progress through X today and where value is created or lost

OBJECTIVE

Understand the end-to-end user journey on X and identify the key moments of value and drop-off across each AARRR stage.

AARRR Stage	Current Journey on X	Value Moment	Key Leak
Acquisition	Users discover X through the logged-out homepage, app store listings, shared post links, embeds on external sites, and word of mouth.	User sees a live breaking story, a creator, or a niche conversation that feels more immediate than any other platform.	Messaging is too broad — X promotes news, AI (Grok), video, audio, creators, DMs and subscriptions all at once. The clearest 'why join now?' is lost.
Activation	Sign up via email, phone, Google or Apple; verify identity; set up profile; follow accounts or Topics; land in For You or Following feed; ideally take a first action.	The feed already feels relevant, OR a first interaction (reply, follow, bookmark) produces immediate visible feedback.	Brittle: identity checks, duplicate phone/email conflicts, possible suspension during setup. Public reviews report sign-up confusion, crashes on mobile and unexpected account locks.
Retention	Ongoing use driven by For You, Following, Explore, Notifications, Bookmarks, Lists, Communities, Spaces and DMs.	X becomes the fastest way to monitor a live topic or stay plugged into a real-time community.	Feed controls are fragmented across tabs, settings and per-post feedback. Poor relevance feels opaque. App often reopens on For You despite users preferring Following.

Revenue	Objective-based advertising, promoted posts, Premium subscription tiers, boosted posts, creator subscriptions and revenue sharing.	Advertisers and users trust X enough to pay for reach, relevance or status.	Mobile Premium costs more than web (app-store fees). Creator monetisation requires 5M organic impressions in 90 days. Only 4% of marketers called X brand-safe (Kantar 2024).
Referral	Mainly content-led: reposts, quote posts, post links, embeds, contact uploads and community invites.	A post escapes the app, reaches a new reader, and gives them a reason to install or return to X.	Strong passive virality but no native invite mechanic. Referral is incidental rather than built into the product.

Identifying Gaps & Growth Opportunities

OBJECTIVE
Analyse each AARRR stage for friction points, drop-offs and missed opportunities, supported by public user feedback and product evidence.

Gap / Bottleneck	Stage	Why It Matters	Evidence
Top-of-funnel promise is too broad	Acquisition	Broad messaging raises awareness but weakens first-session clarity. Users need one clear reason to sign up — not eight.	Homepage says 'See what's happening' while listings simultaneously push Grok, Spaces, long video, DMs, communities and Premium.
Sign-up and re-entry are too brittle	Activation	A user who can't get past verification never activates — wasting already-acquired demand, the most expensive kind to lose.	X requires unique email/phone per account. Reviews describe OTP failures, suspension after deactivation, and crashes when adding existing accounts on mobile.
Cold-start relevance is under-supported	Activation	Recommendation quality depends on signals X doesn't have yet for new users. A generic or noisy first session means the user leaves before the system can learn.	X's own docs confirm relevance is built from follows, likes, replies and media watched — signals a brand-new user hasn't yet given.
Feed controls are fragmented	Retention	If users can't easily push the feed toward 'people I follow, less junk', disengagement becomes rational. Control should be front-row, not a scavenger hunt.	Controls are split across For You vs Following toggle, 'Not interested', muted words, notification filters and topic settings. App Store reviews flag the feed resetting to For You.

Monetisation asks for trust before proving value	Revenue	If subscriptions feel expensive or unfair, conversion drops and sentiment worsens — hurting both direct revenue and ad inventory quality.	Mobile Premium costs more than web due to app-store fees. Creator revenue share requires Premium plus 5M impressions in 90 days and 500 verified followers.
Referral is under-productised	Referral	X creates cultural moments that spread across the web but captures almost none of the resulting acquisition. This is the clearest untapped growth lever.	X documentation heavily favours content sharing (embeds, links) over explicit user-invite mechanics. No native invite loop exists.

> Core conclusion: X's problem is not that nobody knows it exists. Too many users must solve a puzzle before the product earns the right to become a habit. The biggest growth opportunity is faster relevance, lower friction and more visible control.

Defining Epics to Drive Growth

Four product initiatives mapped from insight to AARRR stage

FOCUS AREAS

Activation and Retention — because X already has reach and a distinct real-time advantage, but usage data shows a weaker daily habit than rivals and reviews still flag first-week friction. The upside is in converting existing demand into habit, not buying more awareness.

INSIGHT → STAGE → EPIC MAPPING

Insight	AARRR Stage	Epic
Sign-up, login and reactivation flows fail too often, burning already-acquired demand before any value is delivered.	Activation	Epic 1 Account Access Rescue
First-session relevance depends on luck, and the first week is under-scaffolded. Early signals define long-term feed quality.	Activation + Retention	Epic 2 Intent-Led First Run
Users need more obvious command over their feed. Fragmented controls erode trust and accelerate churn.	Retention	Epic 3 Feed Control Centre & Reset
Outside live events, casual users have no recurring reason to open X. The daily-habit gap is the platform's biggest retention weakness.	Retention	Epic 4 Reasons to Return

EPIC DEFINITIONS

Epic 1 Account Access Rescue [Activation]

INSIGHT	Account creation and re-entry are too brittle. Users bounce before they ever experience value.
WHAT TO BUILD	• Detect duplicate email / phone conflicts before showing a dead-end error — offer recovery instead. • Fix OTP delivery reliability and preserve sign-up progress if verification interrupts the flow. • Build a dedicated reactivation flow: returning high-intent users should not land in a suspension state. • Harden 'add existing account' behaviour on mobile where crashes are most reported.

Epic 2 Intent-Led First Run [Activation + Retention]

INSIGHT	First-session relevance depends too much on luck. The first week is the highest-leverage window X has — and it is under-used.
WHAT TO BUILD	• Day 0 — Replace generic onboarding with an explicit intent choice (news, sports, communities, creators, professional, local) and pre-build the user's interest graph before they see a cold feed. • Day 0 — Let users preview the feed they are about to get, not just a list of accounts to follow. • Days 1–7 — Give every new or reactivated user a lightweight seven-day path: first follow, first bookmark, first reply, first community, first notification preference, first post. • Tie each action to a visibly better feed — not to badges. Show users why the action made X better for them.

Epic 3 Feed Control Centre & Reset [Retention]

INSIGHT	Users feel the algorithm is happening to them, not for them. Controls exist but are buried.
WHAT TO BUILD	• Create a single, obvious 'Control my feed' button on the Home screen — no settings digging required. • Offer simple, plain-language toggles: 'More from people I follow', 'Less political content', 'Fewer reposts', 'More live / local topics'. • Make 'Why am I seeing this?' explanations inline and meaningful — one tap should reduce that content type visibly. • Add a 'Reset my interests' option for users who feel stuck in a stale or irrelevant feed.

Epic 4 Reasons to Return [Retention]

INSIGHT	Outside live events, casual users lack a recurring reason to open X. The daily-habit gap is the core retention problem.

WHAT TO BUILD	
	• Build opt-in live-topic hubs for interests the user has already signalled (e.g. a sport, show, community or beat). • Replace volume-based push notifications with relevance-based ones: 'Big news in a topic you follow' beats 'XYZ liked your post'. • Offer an optional weekly digest — the best content a user missed, surfaced as a card or light push, not a marketing email. • Default new users to quiet mode — let them opt in to more, rather than opting out of noise.

Step 4

Prioritise Using RICE Framework

Scoring each epic to decide what to build first

OBJECTIVE

Score each Epic against Reach, Impact, Confidence and Effort. Rank them to produce a clear build sequence.

SCORING GUIDE

Dimension	Scale	Notes
Reach	1 – 10	Estimated share of quarterly active users touched by the epic
Impact	3 = Massive | 2 = High | 1 = Medium | 0.5 = Low	Standard RICE magnitudes — effect on the target metric if the epic ships
Confidence	0.0 – 1.0	How directly public evidence supports the hypothesis
Effort	1 – 10 (relative)	Cross-functional build effort; higher = more expensive
RICE Score	(Reach × Impact × Confidence) ÷ Effort	Scores are directional — X publishes no internal funnel data

RICE SCORES

Epic	Stage	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE Score
Epic 1 — Account Access Rescue	Activation	6	3.0	0.80	4	3.60 ★ #1
Epic 2 — Intent-Led First Run	Activation + Retention	8	3.0	0.65	8	1.95 ★ #2
Epic 3 — Feed Control Centre & Reset	Retention	9	2.0	0.70	7	1.80 ★ #3
Epic 4 — Reasons to Return	Retention	8	2.0	0.60	6	1.60 ★ #4

PRIORITISATION RATIONALE

- Fix access first (Epic 1). If sign-up, reactivation or add-account flows fail, nothing downstream matters. Highest impact, lowest effort, strongest evidence. Do this now.
- Fix the first run second (Epic 2). Attacks the biggest post-sign-up risk — irrelevant first sessions in a product that lives and dies on early signals. High reach and impact, but a larger build.
- Fix feed control third (Epic 3). Touches the entire active base and rebuilds trust, but consolidating fragmented controls is non-trivial and its effect is slower-moving.

- Build reasons to return last (Epic 4). High value for lapsing users, but notification and habit interventions are harder to calibrate — best shipped once the first run reliably produces engaged users worth bringing back.

> Sequencing note: Revenue and Referral are intentionally excluded from this build sequence. Referral is the most under-productised lever in the whole analysis — X creates cultural moments that spread everywhere but captures little of the resulting acquisition. The right move is to fix the funnel first, then productise sharing and invite mechanics once new arrivals reliably find value. Revenue follows the same logic: a healthier Activation and Retention base lifts ad-inventory quality and subscription willingness far more durably than pushing monetisation into a fragile experience.

ONE-LINE SUMMARY

Fix access → fix the first run → fix control → build reasons to return. X already has the audience scale, the event-driven use case and the distribution surfaces. What it lacks is a reliably sharp first week and a reason to return on an ordinary day. That is the real growth opportunity.

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